■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, September 22, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Largest wildlife overpass in North America located in Colorado with 91% reduction in collisions: "Big success"*

The Angle: *It's North America's biggest wildlife overpass, and it's slashing animal-vehicle collisions by 91% — a rare good-news infrastructure story with an easy visual (deer strolling over a highway) that plays everywhere, not just Colorado.*

- It's the **largest wildlife overpass in North America** — built specifically in **Colorado**
- Animal-vehicle collisions in the area dropped **91%** since it opened
- Officials are calling it a **"big success"**

The Debate Starter

- Would you want your tax dollars building animal bridges — or is that money better spent elsewhere?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbsnews.com/colorado/news/largest-wildlife-overpass-north-america-colorado-reduce-wildlife-collisions/

■ *Martha’s Rule Has Potentially Saved 446 Lives in England by Giving Patients, Loved Ones and NHS Staff the Right to Request a Rapid Review of Care When They Fear Someone Is Deteriorating. After More Than 10,000 Calls, It Is Now Being Expanded to Every A&E, Including Waiting Rooms.*

The Angle: *It's a simple, replicable idea: if a patient or their family feels like something's wrong, they can force a rapid second look — no waiting on doctors to notice. It's spreading fast because it's working, and it's the kind of story that makes people ask 'why don't we have this here?'*

- **Martha's Rule** gives patients, families, and NHS staff the right to demand a rapid review if they fear someone is deteriorating
- It's credited with potentially saving **446 lives** in England so far
- There have been more than **10,000 calls** made under the rule
- It's now expanding to **every A&E department**, including waiting rooms

The Debate Starter

- Would you trust your gut enough to override a doctor and demand a second opinion — and should every hospital here have a rule like this?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/society/2026/sep/22/marthas-rule-expanded-nhs-england

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■■ *Trump flexes 'American power' on UN's biggest stage*

The Angle: *The President used the world's biggest diplomatic stage to double down on using US military force to push out foreign rivals from our own backyard — that's the kind of bold, quotable geopolitics that gets phones ringing and opinions flying.*

- **President Trump** addressed the **United Nations** and defended using American military power to protect US interests.

- He specifically called out **"hostile foreign adversaries"** trying to gain a foothold in the **Western Hemisphere**.
- The speech doubles as a message to rivals *and* allies about how far the US is willing to go to keep its influence close to home.

The Debate Starter

- Is 'flexing military power' smart strategy or reckless saber-rattling on the world stage — where do you land?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/trump-un-general-assembly-speech-9.7353658?cmp=rss

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■ *British Columbia's next provincial election set for Oct. 24 after Eby calls early vote*

The Angle: *British Columbia's next provincial election set for Oct. 24 after Eby calls early vote*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/livestory/british-columbia-snap-election-2026-ndp-leader-david-eby-9.7349059?cmp=rss

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■ *Terrifying mugshot shows homeless man who chased California college student into her apartment*

The Angle: *A California college student says she was chased into her own home by a homeless man - and her blunt takedown of police inaction is striking a nerve on a story that taps into the national homelessness and public-safety debate.*

- A **California college student** says she was chased into her apartment by a **homeless man**, whose mugshot has now surfaced.
- Her reaction: **"You guys don't do anything until it's too late."**
- She added: **"This happens too often to too many people."**

The Debate Starter

- Ask listeners: does your city/campus actually respond before something like this escalates, or only after?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/22/us-news/scary-mugshot-shows-man-who-chased-uc-berkeley-student-to-apartment/

Backup options:

■ *Trump says U.S. to continue buying Canadian potash but wants cheaper price*

The Angle: *It's the classic Trump trade move: keep the deal, squeeze the price. With fertilizer costs hitting everything from farm bills to grocery prices, this is a US-Canada story with real pocketbook stakes on both sides of the border.*

- **Trump** says the U.S. will **keep buying** Canadian potash
- But he wants it at a **cheaper price**
- **Potash** is a key ingredient in fertilizer, tying this directly to **farming and food costs**
- Comes amid the broader back-and-forth over **U.S.-Canada trade terms**

The Trade Talk

- Is this smart negotiating or just squeezing a neighbor who doesn't have much choice?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiwwFBVV95cUxQdUVTUV9HTzJ3U1lKakdMajdoSFdJZ0hMRUl6aUNWS2lSY29oV1pfU1AtWXRQbHFheFZXX3VaU0FWM0ZaOFRiT0VhcFFwUXM5Vjd5N1lRMEgzOGtFOWpKRTl4dl9LV1N1VkdZLUNEX2o2cFhUblEybk9HbGRXTlZLc3Jxckt2XzRLSnV4cmJ4QkU0bExUZzU2LTM5QkNHd2dnVjRncFYzZDFsYXpwTzE2RnNYMTg5OTZXeDk1Y01RQVp5bE0?oc=5

■ *Melania Trump breaks with the U.S. president on media ban*

The Angle: *A First Lady openly disagreeing with her own husband's White House policy is rare enough to stop the scroll - and when it's about restricting media access, it's the kind of family-vs-politics split that makes for*

instant water-cooler talk.

- Reports indicate **Melania Trump** has broken publicly with **President Trump** over a **media ban**.
- Story surfaced via **CTV News**, signaling cross-border pickup in **Canada** as well as the **U.S.**
- Limited detail available beyond the headline - full specifics on the ban and her comments still emerging.

The Debate Starter

- When the First Lady disagrees with the President in public, is that a crack in the marriage or a smart political move?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimAFBVV95cUxPVzladDdkR3JyamoxTUZBc1pIakt2MzVmMG5laXRFRGtSd3dfZDFfaXRfVjI3VFRlaEQ4TGJUUWhyT0pNdGhUVzdxNnFheUNwN0tCOWtoVld4MFJfU3RBanFOeFhuTkdSWFFFMzVENnRmbkNqay1BWG5McjV5U2Z5NmJ4SnZBTmMxQ2xpcHpYOWpNcGhUVk1RRA?oc=5

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Canada nearing free-trade deals with the Philippines, ASEAN block, Trade Minister says*

The Angle: *Canada's Trade Minister says we're getting close to free-trade agreements with the Philippines and the entire ASEAN bloc - a move that could open up new markets and supply chains right as Canada looks to lean less on trade with the U.S.*

- **Canada's Trade Minister** says free-trade talks with the **Philippines** are nearing completion.
- A separate deal is also close with the **ASEAN bloc** - the 10-country Southeast Asian trading group.
- Specifics on tariffs, timelines, and which industries benefit haven't been released yet.

The Big Picture

- New trade lanes with Southeast Asia could mean more product choice and competition on Canadian shelves down the line.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/business/article-canada-nearing-free-trade-deals-with-the-philippines-asean-block/

■ *'They owe me a new vehicle': Ontario man shocked after 3-week-old truck needs new engine*

The Angle: *It's the nightmare every new-car buyer thinks about - you drop serious cash on a brand-new vehicle and it grenades itself before the plates even feel broken in. Instant relatable outrage for anyone who's ever fought a dealership or warranty department.*

- **Ontario** man says his truck needed a **brand-new engine** after just **3 weeks** of ownership
- His reaction, in his own words: **"They owe me a new vehicle"**
- Story surfaced on **Reddit's r/canada**, where it's stirring up debate over lemon laws and dealer accountability

The Phone-In Trigger

- Would you accept a repair on a 3-week-old vehicle, or demand a full replacement - call in and tell us your worst new-car horror story.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/toronto/consumer-alert/article/they-owe-me-a-new-vehicle-ontario-man-shocked-after-3-week-old-truck-needs-new-engine/

■ *Danielle Smith floats charging temporary residents $1,900 to access public health care*

The Angle: *Alberta votes October 19th on whether temporary residents should pay out of pocket to use public health care and schools — a referendum question that cuts right into the immigration and cost-of-living debate.*

- **Danielle Smith** floated a **$1,900** fee for certain non-permanent residents to access Alberta's health care system
- **Albertans** vote in a referendum on **Oct. 19** on the issue

- The referendum question asks about charging a "**reasonable fee or premium**" for access to health care **and** education systems
- The policy would target **non-permanent residents**, not citizens or permanent residents

The Debate Starter

- Should temporary residents pay extra for health care and schools, or is that a two-tier system in disguise?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/alberta-danielle-smith-health-care-fee-9.7354117?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Modi to visit Canada as Carney looks to finalize trade deal with India by end of year*

The Angle: *This is a full 180 after years of Canada-India relations being in the deep freeze — now they're talking trade deals and state visits, which is the kind of political whiplash that makes for good watercooler talk.*

- **Narendra Modi** is expected to visit **Canada in December**
- **PM Mark Carney** confirmed the trip on **Tuesday**
- Both countries are pushing to **finalize a trade deal by the end of the year**
- The visit is being read as a sign the **"deep diplomatic chasm"** between the two nations is finally closing

The Comeback Story

- This relationship was basically frozen solid not long ago — so what changed, and who blinked first, Ottawa or New Delhi?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/modi-canada-trade-deal-visit-9.7354352?cmp=rss

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■ *PM Carney touts ‘fertilizer independence’ as Trump says U.S. will keep buying Canadian potash. Live updates here.*

The Angle: *A Canadian PM bragging about cutting reliance on the U.S. right as Trump says he'll keep buying anyway is a made-for-radio power flex in the middle of the trade tension saga.*

- **PM Mark Carney** is pushing the idea of **'fertilizer independence'** for Canada
- **Donald Trump** says the **U.S.** will keep buying **Canadian potash** regardless
- Potash is the key ingredient in fertilizer - and Canada is the world's biggest supplier of it

The Debate Starter

- Is this Carney flexing independence, or is Canada still stuck needing the U.S. to actually buy the stuff?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirgFBVV95cUxPbkdOSXB6aVYxNkNqbWYydlJIQWdYUjRWeGd5UVNsTFhTTEtNbnpRcGlKd3p6WFEyMUlOUzdEU0Z4WlJpc3BhZk43clVORF9zOFR5eVdPMkdhZTZmVDZvSnZQRWFVd2tBc1pmbUFURFVlUkRYbXR5YzRjTURjaU9BZzFfS2toeFZQVk9UaWd3OWduOWlFcE1aWk9fZXllbThzR1Y2dDYtS196NkJSSEE?oc=5

■ *Could Canadians handle a 32-hour workweek?*

The Angle: *The 32-hour workweek debate keeps resurfacing as burnout and work-life balance dominate water-cooler talk — this is a guaranteed opinion-splitter between hosts who'd love it and bosses who'd panic.*

The Debate Starter

- Call in: would you trade a day off for a pay cut, or is 'same pay, less work' the only version you'd take?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiigFBVV95cUxPT2VOTEsxLW9XX2I2cEk0MmlKVGtBc2FVc0NJUVY0NEVkakhLR29Hd2t0UFdRU0VwUVpwTmlSUXpjSGdvVU5KSXNhcWg2VllGR0x6Tkl6ZHJJcXFkQkZyOUZzZzlyVFN6aWdJbmxlaHVCVnNsSS1PR3VYYVM0ZnQ4TG5WM0szTTVTVGc?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *'The Housewife' Review: Naomi Watts Anchors a Watchable but Underpowered True Story of Hidden Nazism in Suburban Queens*

The Angle: *It's based on a real case — a Queens housewife who was secretly a former Nazi camp guard — and the true story angle is what makes this one worth a mention even if the movie itself is getting mixed reviews.*

- **Naomi Watts** stars as immigrant homemaker **Hermine Ryan**, born **Hermine Braunsteiner**, in a true story set in suburban Queens
- Variety's review calls the film **"watchable but underpowered,"** knocking heavy-handed direction and scripting
- The twist — Hermine's hidden Nazi past — is telegraphed early, with the review noting **"you'll figure out the secret... long before the relevant authorities do"**
- Despite the script issues, the review praises Watts' performance for its **"detail and integrity"**

The Debate Starter

- Would you want to know if the quiet neighbor down the street was hiding a secret like that?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/the-housewife-review-naomi-watts-1236870548/

■ *"Best MAGA event in the country" Freedom Fest ft. Kid Rock and more cancelled after selling 'only 6 VIP tickets'*

The Angle: *A patriotic mega-festival branded as the country's premier MAGA event got quietly cancelled after barely selling any VIP tickets — the gap between the hype and the actual turnout is the kind of self-inflicted comedy that writes itself.*

- Event was marketed as the **'Best MAGA event in the country'**
- Lineup reportedly included **Kid Rock** and other acts
- Organizers cancelled the show, dubbed **Freedom Fest**, after selling just **6 VIP tickets**

The Flop Reaction

- Six VIP tickets — is that a brand problem, a booking problem, or just bad timing?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Guess the Flop** - 60-second warm-up before diving into the story -> Each host guesses how many VIP tickets they think 'Freedom Fest' actually sold before revealing the real number: 6.
- **Step 2: Rebrand It** - Quick improv bit -> Hosts pitch a new name/lineup for a 'Freedom Fest 2.0' that might actually sell tickets.

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://app.ekkow.com/1475004780508709161

■ *Mahershala Ali Says 'I Agree' That Marvel Not Making 'Blade' Is the 'Biggest Failure' of Kevin Feige's Career: 'I Don't Know Why It Didn't Happen'*

The Angle: *An Oscar winner is publicly agreeing that scrapping the 'Blade' reboot is Kevin Feige's biggest career failure — that's an A-lister taking a real shot at the MCU's boss, and superhero fans have been asking 'what happened to Blade?' for years.*

- **Mahershala Ali** says 'I agree' that not making **Blade** is the 'biggest failure' of **Kevin Feige**'s career
- Ali's quote: 'I don't know why it didn't happen'
- The **Blade** reboot has been stuck in Marvel development hell for years, cycling through directors and rewrites
- Ali was cast as **Blade** back in 2019 and the film still hasn't gotten off the ground

The Debate Starter

- Ask listeners: is Blade Marvel's biggest missed opportunity, or is there a bigger MCU botch job out there?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/mahershala-ali-blade-failure-kevin-feige-1236872401/

■ *Robin Williams's daughter Zelda slams deepfake video of her dad*

The Angle: *AI deepfakes of dead celebrities are becoming a real ethical flashpoint, and Zelda Williams just put a human face on why it's not harmless internet fun.*

- **Zelda Williams**, daughter of **Robin Williams**, publicly called out AI-generated deepfake videos of her late father
- The clips reportedly show a fake **Robin Williams** discussing **conspiracy theories** he never actually talked about
- She used her social media platform to debunk the videos and defend his legacy

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between AI tribute and digital grave-robbing when it's someone's actual dead parent?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/robin-williams-deepfake-video-9.7353857?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Yankees lose AL East to Rays with Game 2 defeat in doubleheader split*

The Angle: *The Yankees just blew their number one regular-season goal, and it happened in the worst way possible — a doubleheader split where the loss that mattered came in Game 2. That's exactly the kind of gut-punch that gets Yankees fans calling in.*

- The **Yankees** have officially lost the **AL East** to the **Rays**.
- It came down to a **doubleheader split** — split the two games, but the **Game 2 loss** sealed the division.
- Missing out on the division title makes their road through the **postseason** tougher from here.

The Debate Starter

- Yankees fans — is losing the division to the Rays a real red flag heading into October, or just a shrug-it-off footnote?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/22/sports/yankees-lose-al-east-to-rays-with-game-2-defeat-in-doubleheader-split/

■ *'Heated Rivalry' star's girlfriend calls out fans for crossing 'huge' boundary: 'Hugely uncomfortable for everyone'*

The Angle: *A celeb couple went public at the Oscars party in March, and now she's publicly drawing a line with fans who crossed it — that's a juicy 'where's the line' debate for a lifestyle audience.*

- The **"Heated Rivalry"** star's girlfriend is calling out fans for crossing a **"huge"** boundary
- She says the behavior has been **"hugely uncomfortable for everyone"**
- The couple made their **red carpet debut** together at the **Vanity Fair Oscars party** back in **March**

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between being a fan and being invasive with a celebrity's real-life relationship?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/22/celebrity-news/heated-rivalry-stars-girlfriend-calls-out-fans-for-crossing-boundary/

■ *'Totally outrageous': Tom Cruise unleashes 'Digger' at star■studded Royal premiere*

The Angle: *Tom Cruise doing anything at a star-studded, royal-adjacent premiere is instant tabloid catnip, and headlines calling it 'totally outrageous' mean there's a fun, over-the-top moment here worth describing on air.*

- Headline calls the moment **'totally outrageous'**
- Went down at a **star-studded Royal premiere**
- **Tom Cruise** was the one who brought the surprise element - a dog(?) named **'Digger'**

The Curiosity Gap

- Who or what is 'Digger,' and does Tom Cruise ever do anything at a premiere that ISN'T over-the-top?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMivwFBVV95cUxPdU5lN243Nk9DeV92WVpCaVVvb1IzUWM3cFVua3N5ZTN2S3VubHpYd183TVpUcUVhbEhPTFV4eUI3VEZKQWZtTTVjOWV6T2wtbTRNMXF5V19mNzJHYlczRURjSFZwenFFNkZsQWN0M2RpUDdWTU8xLUtDLUdEVENlTno2c1JmanhuRUFHT2c2MjRWei1PX3d1VFBzZ3VfTDlkZEU2T1RjaENqcFRTZW1uQ2JOR3ZUTmlnWmdGR044OA?oc=5

■ *Tom Cruise Says AI Is ‘Coming and It’s Going to Happen,’ but ‘People Want to See Real Things’: ‘Keep Creating’ - Variety*

The Angle: *Hollywood's AI panic meets its biggest movie star, who's basically betting his whole career on practical stunts and real film over anything synthetic — perfect setup for a debate on where audiences actually stand.*

- **Tom Cruise** says AI is "**coming and it's going to happen**" for the film industry
- He insists "**people want to see real things**" on screen despite the tech threat
- Cruise's message to filmmakers: "**keep creating**"
- Comments came at a **BAFTA "Life in Pictures"** sit-down in London

The Debate Starter

- Team Cruise: do you actually care if what you're watching is real, or does a good story just work either way?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/tom-cruise-ai-movies-people-want-real-things-1236871464/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *KPMG manager Yuen Lee placed on administrative leave after billionaire Bill Ackman shares viral, out-of-context gym altercation video*

The Angle: *A billionaire's tweet turned a heated gym argument into a firing in hours, and it's reigniting the fight over cancel culture, due process, and how much power a viral clip should have over someone's livelihood.*

- **Yuen Lee**, a manager at **KPMG**, was caught on video shouting "Zionist pig" during a confrontation at **Chelsea Piers Fitness**.
- Billionaire **Bill Ackman** and the account **StopAntisemitism** posted the clip and directly tagged **KPMG**, pushing for consequences.
- **KPMG** put her on administrative leave almost immediately after the post went viral.
- The video reportedly starts mid-argument, leaving out whatever happened right before the outburst.

The Debate Starter

- Should a stranger's out-of-context video be enough to get you suspended from your job?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/ren7x9slt2rh1

Backup options:

■ *P.E.I. orchard owner 'fed up' after children damage apples during U-pick visit*

The Angle: *A frustrated orchard owner's rant about kids bruising and tossing apples during U-pick visits has gone viral, tapping into a much bigger debate about parenting, manners, and how we treat small businesses when we visit them.*

- A **Prince Edward Island** orchard owner posted online saying they're **"fed up"** with the damage
- The complaint centers on **children damaging apples** during **U-pick visits**
- The post has **blown up online**, turning into a wider conversation about U-pick etiquette

The Debate Starter

- Is it the kids, or the parents not watching them — who's actually responsible when your family visits a U-pick farm?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/prince-edward-island/pei-wintermoor-orchard-children-damage-apples-9.7353630?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *From April 2027, people in Great Britain who experience pregnancy loss before 24 weeks will have a legal right to up to two weeks of unpaid bereavement leave, including after miscarriage or unsuccessful IVF. The new rules also extend bereavement leave to more family relationships.*

The Angle: *Starting April 2027, Britain becomes one of the first places to legally guarantee bereavement leave after pregnancy loss or failed IVF — a policy shift that's already sparking the obvious question: why doesn't everywhere else have this?*

- Applies to pregnancy loss **before 24 weeks**, including miscarriage and unsuccessful **IVF**
- Grants up to **two weeks of unpaid bereavement leave**
- Takes effect **April 2027** in Great Britain
- Rules also **expand bereavement leave to more family relationships**, not just pregnancy loss

The Debate Starter

- Should paid (not just unpaid) miscarriage leave be the norm everywhere, and does your workplace already offer anything like this?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.manchestereveningnews.co.uk/news/uk-news/andy-burnham-government-confirms-major-34651082.amp

Backup options:

■ *Singapore is planting 1 million more trees by 2030 as research shows well placed shade can cut outdoor heat stress by up to 5°C. Measurements in the city found shaded locations provided significant relief during extreme heat, while models suggest trees could also reduce summer cooling energy use.*

The Angle: *It's a simple, feel-good fix to a problem everyone deals with — free shade that actually cools you down — and the numbers behind it are wild enough to make you rethink your own backyard.*

- **Singapore** is planting **1 million more trees** by **2030**.
- Research shows well-placed shade can cut outdoor heat stress by up to **5°C**.
- City measurements found shaded spots gave major relief during extreme heat.
- Models suggest the trees could also cut **summer cooling energy use**.

The Debate Starter

- Would you rather your city plant a million trees or hand out AC rebates — which actually fixes the heat problem?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/singapore-million-trees-heat-shade/37014/

■ *One in Three Gen Z Men Hasn't Masturbated in 90 Days*

The Angle: *This one's pure watercooler bait — a viral stat claiming a third of young men have gone three months without, well, taking care of business, and it's got the internet debating whether Gen Z is burned out, touch-starved, or just lying on surveys.*

- The viral claim: **one in three Gen Z men** say they haven't masturbated in **90 days**.

- Story is making the rounds via **r/nottheonion**, so treat the number as an internet stat to react to, not a peer-reviewed study.

The Debate Starter

- Fellas, be honest — is that number wildly believable or total internet nonsense?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Gut Check Guess** - Before the reveal -> Both hosts guess what percentage of Gen Z men they THINK the real number is before saying it out loud.
- **Step 2: The Reveal** - Drop the stat -> Reveal the '1 in 3' claim and react — surprised, skeptical, or 'yeah that tracks'?
- **Step 3: Open The Lines** - Caller/text bit -> Ask listeners to weigh in anonymously: dating app burnout, stress, or is the stat just made up?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.playboy.com/read/sex-relationships/gen-z-sex-survey-masturbation

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *How to watch Matthew McConaughey, Woody Harrelson in 'Brothers' for free*

The Angle: *Real-life buddies Matthew McConaughey and Woody Harrelson play brothers on screen, and the movie's free to stream right now — that's an easy watercooler tip for anyone hunting for something to watch tonight.*

- **Matthew McConaughey** and **Woody Harrelson** star as brothers in the new comedy **'Brothers'**
- It's described as **'heartfelt, chaotic and wildly funny'**
- The story is partially inspired by the actors' own real lives
- You can watch it for free right now

The Watch Party Pick

- Free movie, real-life besties playing brothers — who's clearing their couch tonight?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/22/entertainment/how-to-watch-new-matthew-mcconaughey-woody-harrelson-show-for-free/

Backup options:

■ *There's no law to ticket the Waymo that drove through a Denver farmers market*

The Angle: *A driverless Waymo rolled straight through a Denver farmers market and there's literally no law on the books to ticket it — because current traffic codes don't know what to do with a car that has no driver to blame.*

- A **Waymo** self-driving vehicle drove through an active **farmers market** in **Denver**
- Local authorities reportedly have **no legal mechanism** to issue a ticket since the vehicle has no human driver
- Story is trending on **r/nottheonion**, framed as a real-life case of rules not catching up to robot cars

The Debate Starter

- If a robot car can't get a ticket, who's actually responsible when it messes up?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.9news.com/article/news/community/transportation/waymo-drives-denver-farmers-market-no-law/73-a55cac7b-9c76-4003-896b-1dd5ad162dea

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *An Ohio solar farm is now home to more than 50 beehives and nearly 3 million honey bees, turning land around its panels into pollinator habitat while veteran beekeepers use the project to train other veterans and first responders.*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate two-birds-one-stone story — solar panels and bees, working the same acreage — and it's got a genuine feel-good twist with veterans and first responders learning to keep hives. Perfect flip-the-script story after a heavy news day.*

- The solar farm now hosts **more than 50 beehives**
- That works out to nearly **3 million honey bees** living on-site
- The land around the panels is being turned into **pollinator habitat**
- **Veteran beekeepers** are using the hives to train **other veterans and first responders**

The Feel-Good Flip

- Would you have guessed a solar farm doubles as a bee sanctuary — and does it change how you think about what to do with all that open land under panels?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/ohio-solar-farm-50-beehives-honey-bees/37148/

■■ *Russian man given 14 days in jail after writing 'Putin is a dickhead' on election ballot*

The Angle: *It sounds like satire, which is exactly why it's blowing up on Reddit's r/nottheonion — a guy gets actual jail time for four words of ballot graffiti, a stark reminder of how zero tolerance for dissent is in Russia's elections.*

- A **Russian man** was sentenced to **14 days in jail**
- His "crime": writing **"Putin is a dickhead"** directly on his official election ballot
- The story's been ricocheting around **r/nottheonion** because it reads like a headline from a satire site

The Debate Starter

- Is 14 days in jail for a ballot joke insane to you, or does it check out for a place like Russia?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://novayagazeta.eu/en/articles/2026/09/22/russian-man-given-14-days-in-jail-after-writing-putin-is-a-dickhead-on-election-ballot-en-news

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BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *This Ranch Survived Russian Occupation. Now Its Horses Are Helping Ukrainian Soldiers Find Peace in the Pastures*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Pairs war trauma with equine therapy and a named ranch that survived Russian occupation — a specific, visual, deeply human Ukraine story that outlets love to amplify right now.

The Angle: *It's a war story with a hopeful twist - soldiers coming back from the front line are finding calm working with horses on a ranch that itself lived through occupation, which is exactly the kind of resilience story that cuts through the grim Ukraine headlines.*

- The ranch itself was under **Russian occupation** before returning to Ukrainian hands.
- The horses are now used in sessions to help **Ukrainian soldiers** decompress and process trauma.
- The story frames the ranch's own survival as mirroring the healing it now offers returning troops.

The Human Interest Angle

- Ever done equine therapy or know someone who has - does the 'horses read your energy' thing actually work?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://united24media.com/life-in-ukraine/this-ranch-survived-russian-occupation-now-its-horses-are-helping-ukrainian-soldiers-find-peace-in-the-pastures-22636

■ *Comerica Park will be renamed to Fifth Third Park starting in 2027*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Detroit sports fans and stadium-naming-rights swaps (Comerica to Fifth Third) reliably ignite local rage and mockery even from a 0-upvote start — this is classic backlash bait.
The Angle: *The Detroit Tigers' home field is swapping naming-rights sponsors, and "Fifth Third Park" is such an inherently goofy mouthful that it landed on r/nottheonion - an easy, harmless laugh for the back half of the show.*

- **Comerica Park**, home of the **Detroit Tigers**, is getting a new name.
- It'll become **Fifth Third Park** starting in **2027**.
- The switch comes from a new stadium naming-rights deal with **Fifth Third Bank**.

The Say-It-Five-Times-Fast Bit

- Try saying "Fifth Third Park" on air three times fast and see who trips first.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Read the name cold** - 10 seconds -> Host A says "Fifth Third Park" out loud, no warning, and reacts to how weird it sounds.
- **Step 2: Speed round** - 20 seconds -> Both hosts race to say "Fifth Third Park" five times fast; first one to fumble it loses.
- **Step 3: Rename hall of fame** - 30 seconds -> Toss out other awkward corporate stadium names to compare it against (e.g. past renames you both remember).

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wxyz.com/sports/fifth-third-detroit-tigers-to-announce-new-name-of-comerica-park-on-monday

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■ *SNICKERS® Launches the World's First Digital Candy Bar for when AI Acts "Hungry"*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A 'digital candy bar for hungry AI' is absurd enough to be a standalone meme/nottheonion classic, tapping the AI-hype-fatigue trend for easy mockery shares.
The Angle: *A legacy snack brand jumping into the AI hype with a literal 'digital candy bar' is exactly the kind of absurd, screenshot-ready marketing stunt that gets people talking and sharing.*

- **SNICKERS®** says it's dropped the **world's first digital candy bar**.
- The gimmick plays off the brand's classic **'you're not you when you're hungry'** tagline — now applied to **AI** acting glitchy or 'hungry.'

The WTF Moment

- Genius brand stunt or proof marketing has officially run out of real ideas?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/snickers-launches-the-worlds-first-digital-candy-bar-for-when-ai-acts-hungry-302863014.html

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■ *It's Donald Trump Versus MAGA on Data Centers | The president has doubled down on data centers and AI. His base is running in the opposite direction.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A president vs. his own base on AI data centers is a specific intra-party fracture story that plays directly into the current AI-backlash trend.
The Angle: *The president is all-in on data centers and AI as an economic win, but MAGA voters are pushing back over land use, power bills, and water — a rare public split between Trump and his own base worth unpacking.*

- **Donald Trump** has doubled down publicly on data centers and AI expansion as a priority
- A growing faction of his own **MAGA base** is pushing back against that build-out
- The rift centers on local costs and impacts tied to data center construction

The Debate Starter

- Would you want a massive AI data center built in your neighborhood if it meant higher power bills?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wired.com/story/donald-trump-versus-maga-on-data-centers

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■■ *Google using search and YouTube history to guess Canadians' ages and could make them show ID*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Google using search/YouTube history to guess ages and demand ID taps a very relatable 'this could happen to me' privacy fear with a surprising mechanism.
The Angle: *Google's rolling out AI age-detection in Canada that scans your search and YouTube history to guess if you're under 18 — and if it thinks you are, you could get hit with a request to show ID. It's a privacy flashpoint that touches literally everyone with a Google account.*

- **Google** is using signals from **search and YouTube history** to estimate whether a user is a **minor**
- Users flagged as underage could be asked to **verify their age**, potentially with **ID**
- The rollout is happening in **Canada**
- It's part of a broader push by tech platforms toward **AI-driven age verification**

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually hand Google your ID to prove you're an adult, or does that cross a line?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dexerto.com/youtube/google-using-search-and-youtube-history-to-guess-canadians-ages-and-could-make-them-show-id-3411331/

■ *People Training OpenAI's AI Fired for Using AI to Train the AI*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): AI trainers fired for using AI to do their AI-training job is a self-contained ironic twist that's inherently quotable and meme-ready.
The Angle: *It's the ultimate AI irony story — people paid to teach the robot got caught letting the robot do their homework, and got axed for it. This is exactly the kind of self-referential AI-industry chaos that keeps going viral right now.*

- Workers hired by **OpenAI** to help train its AI models were reportedly **fired**
- The reason: they were using **AI tools** to help complete the very training work they were hired to do
- The twist practically writes itself — humans training AI, replaced for outsourcing their job... to AI

The Irony Alert

- If your job is literally to teach the robot, and you get caught letting the robot teach itself — were you actually wrong?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.404media.co/people-training-openais-ai-fired-for-using-ai-to-train-the-ai/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: 'Wtf come on'" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 17 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)

Newly banked this run:
- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’ - ew.com"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-22 11:41 PM